PEAK-PERIOD OPERATIONS AND QUEUE ESCALATION SOP

General International Airport (fictional)

Document no.	GIA-SOP-06	**Version**	1.3
Status	APPROVED	**Classification**	Internal
Effective	1 March 2026	**Next review**	1 March 2027
Owner	Director, Airport Operations	**Approved by**	Operations Board (decision OB-2026-004, 16 February 2026)
Supersedes	Queue Escalation SOP v1.2		

This is a fictional document created for training purposes.

Section 1. Purpose

1.1 This procedure tells the duty manager what to do when queues build up, so that no passenger waits longer than the service standards allow.

Section 2. Escalation levels

2.1 Level 1: the average departure immigration wait in the last hour is above 20 minutes. The duty manager opens any reserve counters in that terminal and informs the border supervisor.

2.2 Level 2: the average departure immigration wait is above 30 minutes for 3 consecutive hours. The duty manager requests additional border staff immediately, records the incident, and notifies the Director, Airport Operations.

2.3 Level 3: individual waits above 45 minutes. The duty manager activates priority lanes for passengers whose flight departs within 90 minutes, informs the airlines, and logs every passenger who misses a flight for rebooking assistance under GIA-SOP-05.

Section 3. Reserve capacity

3.1 Terminal 1 has 14 departure immigration counters installed and Terminal 2 has 9. Counters installed but not rostered are reserve capacity.

3.2 Reserve capacity may be opened within 15 minutes of a Level 1 trigger if border staff are available.

Section 4. Smart gates

4.1 Automated smart gates operate at Terminal 1 departures from 1 July 2026. Use is voluntary and open to eligible resident and work permit holders.

4.2 Smart gates reduce load on staffed counters but do not replace the minimum counters in GIA-STD-03.

4.3 A smart gate outage longer than 30 minutes is recorded as an incident and the duty manager reviews the staffed counters.

Section 5. Monitoring and reporting

5.1 The control room reviews the sampled waiting times every hour in peak hours.

5.2 Each Level 2 or Level 3 event is reported to the Customer Experience Committee in the monthly compliance report.